Cover Letter — Not for Submission Yet

Status: author declarations and persistent archive identifier pending.

21 August 2026

Editors
Learning and Individual Differences

Dear Editors,

Please consider the full length article, “Ability Concealment Does Not Uniquely Reveal the Environment: Learning and Social Opportunity in Gifted Learners.”

The manuscript addresses an educational inference problem: similar observed ability concealment can arise from differences in learning history, action representation, persistent social consequences, contextual discoverability, or current environmental conditions. The paper therefore separates observed behaviour from the environmental and learned processes that may produce it. Across five controlled reinforcement-learning experiments, it distinguishes current reward, learned value, dynamic value, and the availability versus discoverability of receptive opportunities.

The work fits *Learning and Individual Differences* because its central question concerns how finite learning and environmental structure can generate individual variation without requiring that observed behavioural differences map directly to stable learner traits. The models are deliberately stylized computational environments, not calibrated psychological replicas or clinical claims. Their contribution is to make competing explanations explicit and to identify the longitudinal and contextual measurements needed to distinguish them empirically.

Source code is available at https://github.com/mousomer/gifted-masking. A content-addressed archive of the frozen E01-E05 publication evidence has been prepared; its verified persistent identifier will be inserted after deposit and before submission.

Sincerely,

Guy Sion, corresponding author
on behalf of Guy Sion and Omer Moussaffi

Production note

Before submission, authors must confirm originality/concurrent-submission status, final authorship and declarations, and the persistent archive identifier. This note must be removed from the uploaded cover letter.